

## **Maria Silva**

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Real Estate Paralegal role at the US law firm through Ryder Reid Legal because my year at BCLP, and specifically my six months in Real Estate Disputes, gave me practical exposure to property matters that I want to develop further in a transactional context.

At BCLP's Real Estate Disputes team I reviewed documents across leasehold, landlord and tenant, rights of light and easements disputes, prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments and maintained matter records on iManage. Handling several matters simultaneously with competing deadlines meant I had to keep case files organised and flag risks early. That experience gave me a working familiarity with the legal and factual issues that sit behind real estate transactions, and it made me want to understand those transactions themselves rather than only their downstream disputes.

To follow that up, I completed the Clifford Chance Real Estate Finance virtual experience programme, which applied financing and security concepts in a transactional setting. That practical exercise clarified for me how due diligence, title review and security documentation fit together in a deal, which is directly relevant to the lease reviews, Land Registry searches and due diligence work this role describes.

Beyond property, my broader legal work has built the organisational habits a small team depends on. At Citizens Advice I manage matters end to end: taking detailed factual statements, identifying evidential gaps, drafting correspondence, maintaining confidential records and meeting submission deadlines. Before that, during my international arbitration rotation at BCLP, I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant procedural deadline and coordinated documents and outstanding actions to ensure on-time submission. A partner and associate told me my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor.

What draws me to a permanent role in real estate specifically, rather than disputes, is that I want to work on transactions as they are structured rather than when they have broken down. A small team in a US firm handling high-quality real estate and real estate finance work is the kind of environment where I would get genuine exposure to a wide range of matters from an early stage, which is what I am looking for at this point.

Yours sincerely,  
Maria Silva